

EMPLOYMENT AGREEMENT

(FICTIONAL SAMPLE — FOR DEMO USE ONLY)

Effective Date:	March 3, 2026
Company:	Asteron Systems, Inc. (Fictional Delaware corporation)
Employee:	Maya R. Patel
Position:	Senior Software Engineer, Platform
Primary Location:	San Jose, California (Hybrid)

Notice: This document is a fabricated sample created for product demonstrations and UI testing. It does not describe any real organization, and it is not legal, HR, or compliance advice. Use of this template in a real employment context should be reviewed by qualified counsel.

Sections: 1) Position & Duties 2) Compensation & Benefits 3) Time Off & Policies 4) Confidentiality & IP
5) Termination & Severance 6) Change in Control / Management Change

Parties and Purpose

This Employment Agreement (“**Agreement**”) is entered into as of the Effective Date by and between **Asteron Systems, Inc.** (“**Company**”) and **Maya R. Patel** (“**Employee**”). Company and Employee may be referred to individually as a “**Party**” and collectively as the “**Parties**.”

The purpose of this Agreement is to set forth the basic terms of Employee's employment with Company, including compensation, duties, confidentiality obligations, and certain conditions applicable in the event of leadership change or corporate transactions.

1. Position; Start Date; Work Location

1.1 Position. Employee will be employed as **Senior Software Engineer, Platform** (“**Position**”). Employee will report to the **Director of Platform Engineering**, or to such other supervisor as Company may designate.

1.2 Start Date. Employee's start date will be **March 18, 2026** (“**Start Date**”).

1.3 Work Location. Employee's primary work location is **San Jose, California**, with a hybrid schedule as reasonably determined by Company policies and business needs.

1.4 Exempt Status. Employee is classified as **exempt** (salaried) under applicable wage and hour laws, where permitted.

2. Duties and Responsibilities

2.1 Core Duties. Employee will perform the duties customary for the Position, including but not limited to: (a) designing, building, and operating backend platform services (APIs, queues, data pipelines, and internal tooling); (b) participating in on-call rotations, incident response, and reliability improvements; (c) leading technical design reviews and mentoring engineers; (d) collaborating cross-functionally with Security, Product, and Infrastructure teams; and (e) writing and maintaining documentation, runbooks, and operational playbooks.

2.2 Standard of Performance. Employee will devote full working time and best efforts to Company business and will comply with Company policies, security requirements, and reasonable managerial directives.

2.3 Duty of Candor. Employee agrees to promptly raise risks, security concerns, and material project blockers, and to communicate status accurately in internal reporting.

3. Compensation

3.1 Base Salary. Company will pay Employee a base salary of **\$172,000 USD per year**, less applicable withholdings, payable in accordance with Company's standard payroll practices.

3.2 Annual Bonus (Target). Employee will be eligible to participate in Company's annual bonus program with a **target bonus of 12%** of base salary, subject to performance and Company discretion. No bonus is guaranteed.

3.3 Equity (If Applicable). Subject to Board approval and plan documents, Employee will be eligible for an equity award of **22,000 stock options** (fictional). Vesting and other terms are governed exclusively by the applicable equity plan and award agreement.

3.4 Benefits. Employee may participate in Company benefit plans as offered, subject to plan terms and eligibility requirements. Benefits may be modified or terminated in Company's discretion, consistent with applicable law.

3.5 Business Expenses. Company will reimburse reasonable business expenses in accordance with Company's expense policy, provided Employee submits timely documentation.

4. Time Off and Leave

4.1 Paid Time Off. Employee will accrue **20 days** of paid time off per year (or as otherwise specified in Company policy), plus Company-recognized holidays.

4.2 Leaves of Absence. Employee is eligible for leave in accordance with applicable law and Company policy.

5. Confidentiality, Security, and Intellectual Property

5.1 Confidential Information. Employee will have access to proprietary information. Employee agrees during and after employment to maintain the confidentiality of all non-public Company information, including code, designs, customer data, pricing, roadmaps, security details, and trade secrets ("**Confidential Information**").

5.2 Security Requirements. Employee must comply with Company security policies (including multi-factor authentication, endpoint controls, least-privilege access, and incident reporting). Employee will promptly report suspected security incidents, data loss, or unauthorized access.

5.3 Work Product and IP Assignment. To the maximum extent permitted by law, Employee assigns to Company all rights, title, and interest in inventions, works of authorship, developments, improvements, and discoveries created in the scope of employment or using Company resources ("**Work Product**"). Employee will execute documents reasonably necessary to perfect such rights.

5.4 Open Source. Employee will comply with Company's open-source review and approval process before introducing open-source components into Company products.

6. Conflicts of Interest; Outside Activities

6.1 No Conflicts. Employee will avoid conflicts of interest and promptly disclose any potential conflicts.

6.2 Outside Work. Employee may not engage in outside employment or consulting that materially interferes with job duties or creates a conflict, without prior written approval from Company.

7. At-Will Employment

Employee's employment is **at-will**. Either Party may terminate employment at any time, with or without cause or notice, subject to Section 8 (Termination; Final Pay; Severance) and applicable law. Nothing in this Agreement creates a guarantee of continued employment.

8. Termination; Final Pay; Severance (Sample)

8.1 Final Pay. Upon termination, Company will provide final compensation and accrued benefits as required by law and policy.

8.2 Return of Property. Employee must return all Company property and access credentials promptly upon termination.

8.3 Severance (Optional Sample). If Company terminates Employee without Cause and Employee signs a standard release of claims, Company will provide: (a) **6 weeks** of base salary continuation, and (b) COBRA premium assistance for **up to 2 months** (if applicable), subject to the release and continued compliance with this Agreement.

9. Change in Upper Management; Merger; Acquisition (Change in Control)

9.1 Organizational Changes. Employee acknowledges that Company may undergo changes including replacement of executive leadership or board members, reorganization, department restructuring, merger, acquisition, sale of assets, or other "change in control" transaction ("**Change in Control**").

9.2 Assumption by Successor. In the event of a Change in Control, this Agreement may be assigned to and assumed by a successor entity. Employee agrees to reasonably cooperate with transition and integration efforts, including reporting-line changes and process/tool migrations.

9.3 Terms Subject to Change. Following a Change in Control or significant upper-management change, Company (or a successor) may update policies and may modify reporting structure, team assignment, job title, responsibilities, bonus-plan metrics, equity-plan administration, benefits, and operating procedures, in each case consistent with applicable law and business needs.

9.4 Compensation Safeguard. Except with Employee's written consent, base salary will not be reduced by more than **10%** as a direct result of a Change in Control. All changes will be communicated in writing and applied prospectively.

9.5 Good Reason Resignation (Sample). If, within **12 months** after a Change in Control, Employee experiences a material adverse change (e.g., base salary reduction greater than 10%, primary work location relocation greater than 35 miles, or a substantial reduction in core responsibilities) and Company does not cure such change within **30 days** after written notice, Employee may resign for "Good Reason" and will be eligible for the severance in Section 8.3, subject to signing a release.

9.6 No Automatic Acceleration. Unless separately stated in an equity award agreement or severance plan, a Change in Control does not automatically accelerate equity vesting.

10. Dispute Resolution; Governing Law

10.1 Governing Law. This Agreement is governed by the laws of the **State of California**, without regard to conflict-of-law rules.

10.2 Venue. Any permitted court proceedings will be brought in **Santa Clara County, California**, unless otherwise required by law.

11. Miscellaneous

11.1 Entire Agreement. This Agreement, plus any referenced policy acknowledgments and equity documents, constitutes the entire agreement regarding employment terms and supersedes prior discussions.

11.2 Amendments. Amendments must be in writing and signed by both Parties, except that Company may update policies as described herein.

11.3 Severability. If any provision is invalid, the remaining provisions remain enforceable.

11.4 Counterparts; Electronic Signatures. This Agreement may be executed electronically and in counterparts.

SIGNATURES

ASTERON SYSTEMS, INC. (Fictional)	EMPLOYEE
By: _____	Signature: _____
Name: Elena Morozova	Name: Maya R. Patel
Title: VP, People & Culture	Date: _____
Date: _____	

Employee acknowledges receipt of Company policies (including Code of Conduct and Information Security Policy) and agrees to comply with them as a condition of employment.